

Lab 1: Introduction to AWS IAM

AWS Technical Essentials

Identity and Access Management

🏷️ Your Student ID — Read This First

> ⚠️ **Everyone in this class shares one AWS account.** Every resource you create must carry your assigned student ID, or it will collide with someone else's.

Your instructor has assigned you an ID such as `user7`. In every lab, wherever you see `<ID>`, type your own ID instead.

The lab shows	You type (if your ID is `user7`)
`lab-user-<ID>`	`lab-user-user7`
`employee-directory-app-sg-<ID>`	`employee-directory-app-sg-user7`

> 💡 **One exception:** S3 bucket names must be unique across *all* of AWS, so Lab 4 adds a random suffix on top of your ID.

> ⚠️ **One Region for the whole course:** set the Region picker (top right

📋 Lab Overview

🎯 Objectives

- Navigate the IAM Dashboard
- Create an IAM User with console access
- Create an IAM Group with a managed policy
- Author a custom scoped IAM Policy
- Test permissions as the new user

📝 Lab Details

- **Duration:** ~15 minutes
- **Level:** Introductory
- **Services:** IAM, S3, EC2
- **Region:** `us-east-1` (N. Virginia) — stay in it all day

✅ Prerequisites

- AWS lab account credentials
- Web browser (Chrome or Firefox)

📈 Explore the IAM Dashboard

1. In the console search bar, type **IAM** and select it
2. Note the **IAM sign-in URL** — copy it for later
3. Review the resource summary: Users, Groups, Roles, Policies

> 💡 **Note:** IAM is a **global service** — not tied to any specific AWS Region.

> ✅ **Expected:** You see the IAM Dashboard with resource counts and the account sign-in URL.

📝 Create an IAM User

1. Click **Users** in the left nav, then **Create user**
2. User name: `lab-user-<ID>`
3. Check **Provide user access to the AWS Management Console**
4. Select **I want to create an IAM user**
5. Set a custom password (e.g., `Lab@User123!`), uncheck "require password reset"
6. Click **Next**
7. Select **Attach policies directly**, search `S3ReadOnly`, check **AmazonS3ReadOnlyAccess**
8. Click **Next**, then **Create user**

> ✅ **Expected:** Success banner. Save the sign-in URL and password — you will need them later.

👥 Create an IAM Group

1. Click **User groups** in the left nav, then **Create group**
2. Group name: `EC2-Admins-<ID>`
3. Under **Add users**, check **lab-user-<ID>**
4. Under **Attach permissions policies**, search and select **AmazonEC2FullAccess**
5. Click **Create user group**

> ✅ **Expected:** EC2-Admins-<ID> group created with lab-user-<ID> as a member and AmazonEC2FullAccess attached.

📜 Create a Custom IAM Policy

1. Click **Policies**, then **Create policy**
2. Switch to the **JSON** tab and paste:

```
{
    "Version": "2012-10-17",
    "Statement": [
        {
            "Effect": "Allow",
            "Action": [
                "s3:ListBucket",
                "s3:GetObject"
            ],
            "Resource": [
                "arn:aws:s3:::employee-directory-app-bucket-<ID>-*",
                "arn:aws:s3:::employee-directory-app-bucket-<ID>-*/*"
            ]
        }
    ]
}
```

3. Click **Next**, name it `S3ScopedReadPolicy-<ID>`, click **Create policy**

🔎 Test Permissions — Sign In as lab-user-<ID>

1. Open an **incognito/private browser window**
2. Navigate to the **IAM sign-in URL** you saved earlier
3. Sign in as **lab-user-<ID>** with the password you set

> ✅ **Expected:** You sign in successfully. Confirm the user name in the top-right corner shows **lab-user-<ID>**.

🔎 Test Permissions — Verify Access

1. Navigate to **S3** — you should be able to **view** buckets
2. Try to **create a bucket** — you should get **Access Denied**
3. Navigate to **EC2** — you should have **full access** (via group)

> ❌ **S3 write = denied:** lab-user-<ID> has read-only S3 access (direct policy).

> ✅ **EC2 = full access:** lab-user-<ID> inherits EC2FullAccess from the EC2-Admins-<ID> group.

🗑️ Clean Up

Return to your **admin session** and delete the following (in order):

1. **Policy:** Policies → search `S3ScopedReadPolicy-<ID>` → Delete
2. **Remove user from group:** User groups → EC2-Admins-<ID> → remove lab-user-<ID>
3. **Group:** User groups → delete EC2-Admins-<ID>
4. **User:** Users → delete lab-user-<ID>

> ✅ **Verify:** lab-user-<ID>, EC2-Admins-<ID>, and S3ScopedReadPolicy-<ID> are all removed.

🎉 Lab 1 Complete!

Introduction to AWS IAM

🎯 Key Takeaways

🛠️ What You Did

- Navigated the IAM Dashboard
- Created an IAM User with console access
- Created a Group with a managed policy
- Authored a custom JSON policy
- Tested permissions across services

📚 Key Concepts

- **IAM is global** — not Region-specific
- **Least privilege** — grant only needed permissions
- **Groups** — manage permissions at scale
- **Default deny** — everything denied unless allowed



Questions?

Ask your instructor before proceeding to the next module